

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 4 3  
 ♥ Q 6 2  
 ♦ Q J  
 ♣ J 9 5 3 2

♠ A K 9 6 5 2

♥ 10 9 8 3

♦ 4

♣ A 8



♠ J 10 8

♥ J 4

♦ A 10 9 8 5 3

♣ 7 4

♠ 7

♥ A K 7 5

♦ K 7 6 2

♣ K Q 10 6

| West      | North | East | South |
|-----------|-------|------|-------|
|           | 1 ♠   | Pass | 2 ♣   |
| Pass      | 2 ♥   | Pass | 3 ♥   |
| Pass      | 4 ♥   |      |       |
| All Pass  |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♣ 7 |       |      |       |

North opens 1 ♠. You have 15 HCP, but you only have 4 ♥s, so you can't bid 2 ♥ (this would promise a 5-card suit). So instead you bid clubs. This is natural and game-forcing, but only promises 4+ clubs. Note that holding two 4-card minors you bid them up-the-line, just as in standard bidding. North rebids 2 ♥. This shows at least 4 hearts. What do you rebid now? Your 3 ♥ bid confirms hearts as trump. There's no worry partner might pass - we are in a game forcing auction. North raises to 4 ♥, showing no slam interest.

We don't have enough for slam opposite a minimum opener, so we just pass. Note North's decision to show the poor 4-card heart suit for their second bid, instead of showing the 6th spade. In a GF sequence, it's more important to tell about 4 more cards than 1 more card. North will always have the chance to rebid spades later if there is no heart fit.

**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 7 5

♥ K 4

♦ A Q J 10 7

♣ K 9 7

♠ Q 10 3

♥ J 10 6 2

♦ K 9 4 2

♣ J 5



♠ A K 9 2

♥ A Q 9 8 3

♦ 8 5

♣ 8 6

♠ J 6 4

♥ 7 5

♦ 6 3

♣ A Q 10 4 3 2

*West**North**East**South*

2♦

Pass

2♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

Lead: ♣J

East opens 1♥ - how do you respond? East next bids 2♠, showing the other Major suit. In standard bidding this is a Reverse, showing a strong hand with 5♥s and 4♠s. But after a 2/1 GF response, East doesn't need extra values to show their 4-card spade suit. What should you rebid? You assume East to be 4-5 in the Majors, and since you can't support either one, you bid 2NT. If East actually has 6♥s (or 5♠s) he would rebid the suit. Your 2NT bid guarantees a stopper in the fourth suit.

East does not have either 6♥s or 5♠s so he just bids 3NT. Notice that East never once considered the possibility of passing what might be a misfit - the initial 2/1 response unconditionally forced the partnership to reach a game somewhere.

**Board 3**

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 5 3  
 ♥ Q 5 4  
 ♦ A Q 4 2  
 ♣ 10 4 3

♠ K 8

♥ J 10 7

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A K J 6 2



♠ Q J 6

♥ K 6 2

♦ J 10 8 3

♣ 9 8 5

♠ A 9 7 4 2

♥ A 9 8 3

♦ K 6

♣ Q 7

| West        | North            | East | South |
|-------------|------------------|------|-------|
|             |                  |      | 1 ♠   |
| Pass        | 2 ♣              | Pass | 2 ♥   |
| Pass        | 3 ♦ <sup>1</sup> | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass    |                  |      |       |
| 1. 4th suit |                  |      |       |

Lead: ♦ 2

South opens 1 ♠ - how do you respond? With 13 points, you respond 2 ♣, a natural 2/1 force to game. South next bids 2 ♥, showing the other Major suit. What do you rebid now? You assume South to be 5-4 in the Majors, so you cannot support either. You cannot bid 2NT without a stopper in ♦ s. So you bid the fourth suit, 3 ♦, telling South you know you must make a bid, but can't find anything appropriate. This is an artificial bid, and normally denies a diamond stopper (otherwise you would have bid 2NT). South rebids 3NT - what do you do now?

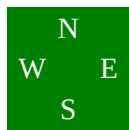
South now must find a bid. His choices include rebidding the 5-card ♠ s, supporting North's ♣ s with a doubleton Queen, or bidding 3NT with the ♦ K 6 as a stopper. He chooses this last option. It appears that 3NT is the best game for these two hands.

**Board 4**

East Deals

Both Vul

|                  |            |             |
|------------------|------------|-------------|
| ♠ A 4            | ♠ 10 9 8 2 | ♠ K J 7 6 3 |
| ♥ K J 10 8 6 5 3 | ♥ 9        | ♥ A Q 7     |
| ♦ K Q            | ♦ 10 8 7 5 | ♦ J 4       |
| ♣ 8 7            | ♣ K 5 4 2  | ♣ A Q J     |



|             |
|-------------|
| ♠ Q 5       |
| ♥ 4 2       |
| ♦ A 9 6 3 2 |
| ♣ 10 9 6 3  |

| West             | North | East             | South |
|------------------|-------|------------------|-------|
|                  |       | 1 ♠              | Pass  |
| 2 ♥              | Pass  | 3 ♥              | Pass  |
| 3 ♠ <sup>1</sup> | Pass  | 4 ♣ <sup>2</sup> | Pass  |
| 4NT              | Pass  | 5 ♠ <sup>3</sup> | Pass  |
| 6 ♥              |       |                  |       |

All Pass

1. control

2. control

3. 2 keycards + trump Q

Lead: ♦ 7

How do you open the bidding? With 18 HCP and a balanced hand, you open 1 ♠. Partner responds 2 ♥. What do you rebid? You know this is a 5-card suit, and bid 3 ♥, confirming the 8+card trump fit and sets the trump suit. Partner rebids 3 ♠, a control bid, showing first or second round control. (Some will play this as showing 3-card support for spades, but I recommend playing this as a control bid.). You bid 4C, also a control bid, showing first or second round control in clubs. Partner bids 4NT, a keycard request using 1430.

You bid 5 ♠, showing two keycards and the trump queen. Partner bids the slam. The slam is a good one. If either the ♠ Q or ♣ K is right there are 12 tricks by way of a finesse. But the best way to play the hand would be to try to establish a ♠ in the East hand, and if that fails try the ♣ finesse.

**Board 5**

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 5 4

♥ 10 6

♦ J 7 2

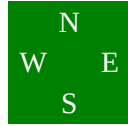
♣ 8 6 5 3

♠ A J 10

♥ A K 9 8 5

♦ K 9 6

♣ Q 7



♠ K Q 2

♥ Q J 4 2

♦ 10 8 5 3

♣ 9 2

♠ 8 6 3

♥ 7 3

♦ A Q 4

♣ A K J 10 4

North opens 1♥ - how should you respond? North rebids 2NT. How do you continue? South shows her minimum by bidding 3NT. North continues with 4NT - what does this mean? How do you continue?

North's 4NT was not Blackwood, but rather a quantitative raise in Notrump, and an invitation to slam. You have 15 points, and they are good ones. So you accept the invitation and bid 6NT. There are 11 top tricks. A 3-3 ♥ split would provide the 12th winner, but this is against the odds. Better to try two ♠ finesses, a 75% chance.

| <i>West</i> | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|-------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
| Pass        | 1♥           | Pass        | 2♣           |
| Pass        | 2NT          | Pass        | 3NT          |
| Pass        | 4NT          | Pass        | 6NT          |
| All Pass    |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♠K    |              |             |              |

**Board 6**

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 6 3  
 ♥ Q 3  
 ♦ A K J 9 4  
 ♣ 9 6 4

♠ K 10  
 ♥ 9 8 7 6 2  
 ♦ 10 7 2  
 ♣ A K 2



♠ A J 8 7 5 2  
 ♥ A K  
 ♦ Q 6  
 ♣ J 8 7

♠ 9 4  
 ♥ J 10 5 4  
 ♦ 8 5 3  
 ♣ Q 10 5 3

East opens 1♠ - You responds 2♦, natural and game forcing. East rebids 2♠. In our style of 2/1, this promises 6+ cards in spades, and denies a side 4-card suit. What should we bid now?

You should jump to 4♠. This is Fast Arrival, indicating a minimum hand with no particular interest in slam. East is happy to rest in the game contract. Even with a combined 30 points, 10 tricks are certainly not a sure thing. East must hope that North holds the trump King.

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          | Pass  | 1♠   | Pass  |
| 2♦       | Pass  | 2♠   | Pass  |
| 4♠       |       |      |       |
| All Pass |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♥J |       |      |       |